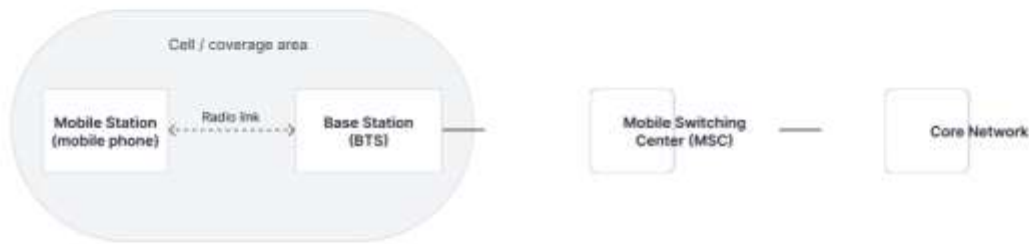


Cellular System Overview

Lab Activity 1



Mobile Station — Details

Mobile Station (MS)

The user's mobile phone. It communicates with the BTS via radio waves (air interface).



Cell / Coverage Area — Details

Cell / Coverage Area

The geographic area served by a BTS. Real coverage depends on terrain, obstacles and signal strength; the shape here is simplified.



Base Station (BTS) — Details

Base Station (BTS)

Transmits and receives radio signals to/from the MS. Converts air interface to physical network signals.



Mobile Switching Center (MSC) — Details

Mobile Switching Center (MSC)

Handles voice-call setup and switching, supports mobility and handover, and connects the radio access side to the core network.



Core Network — Details

Core Network

The backbone of the cellular network. Routes calls and data to other networks (PSTN, Internet).

